

Supplementary Material 1

The beam was aligned by adjusting the lens position until the spot appeared sufficiently small. To ensure reproducibility, the procedure was repeated several times, usually after someone accidentally moved a component.

Additional measurements were performed by placing a screen before and after the estimated focal plane. As expected, the spot became larger in both directions, confirming that the smallest spot was somewhere in between. The final lens position was marked with tape to discourage further improvements.